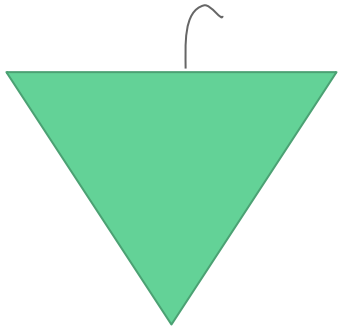


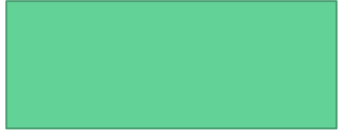
CRITICAL / ANALYTICAL ESSAY

What is this and how to write it

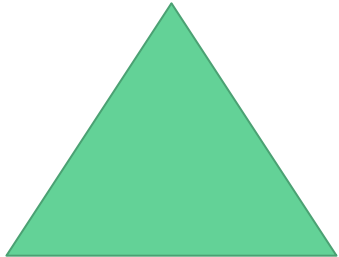
THE FORMAT



Beginning - Introduction (general to specific)



Main - 3 body paragraphs (additional is optional)



Ending - conclusion (specific to general)

INTRODUCTION

Hook - first few sentences which grab the reader's attention and introduction of the topic

AGTT - author, genre, title, theme

Context - Info on character and theme (Background/Goal, Conflict/Obstacle, Result/Realization)

Thesis statement - main argument

HOOK

- General statement → discussion of the topic, theme, ideas presented in the question
- Rhetorical question + answer → discussion opened with a question that is immediately answered and discussed
- Quote → often of a famous writer or philosopher that will add to your discussion of the topic (needs to be memorized prior)
- Anecdotal → create a anecdote or relatable analogy to enter your discussion of the topic

AGTT → CONTEXT → THESIS

Author, genre, title of the text → lead into your analysis of **character and connect to the controlling idea**:

(Context)

- background/goal
- conflict/obstacle
- the realization/result

This should lead you into the **thesis** or generalization that addresses the topic.
The thesis can be 1 - 2 sentences

CONTEXT

- **Character/Background:** Chris lives in a **fantasy world** where he **imagines** that his past and present life is much more successful and glamorous than it is in reality.
- **Goal/Purpose:** looking for contentment by means of escaping the real world. Does this by creating **imaginary or fabricated** stories.
- **Conflicts:** Chris' reality is harsh and he can't face it. He enlists in the war and is forced to face the harsh reality of his life and mental state.
- **Realization/Result:** As a result Chris sees the horror of war and retreats into madness to escape this reality.

THESIS

- Discuss the main theme of your essay
 - Highlight your argument and stance - what you will be discussing
 - Mention the topic in the question
- *Reword for clarity and vocab (you should be rewriting it 3 times to enhance it)

Thesis - Choose one set of words

Body 1

Somebody wanted

Goal

From

Cause

Body 2

But

Conflict

Through

Effect

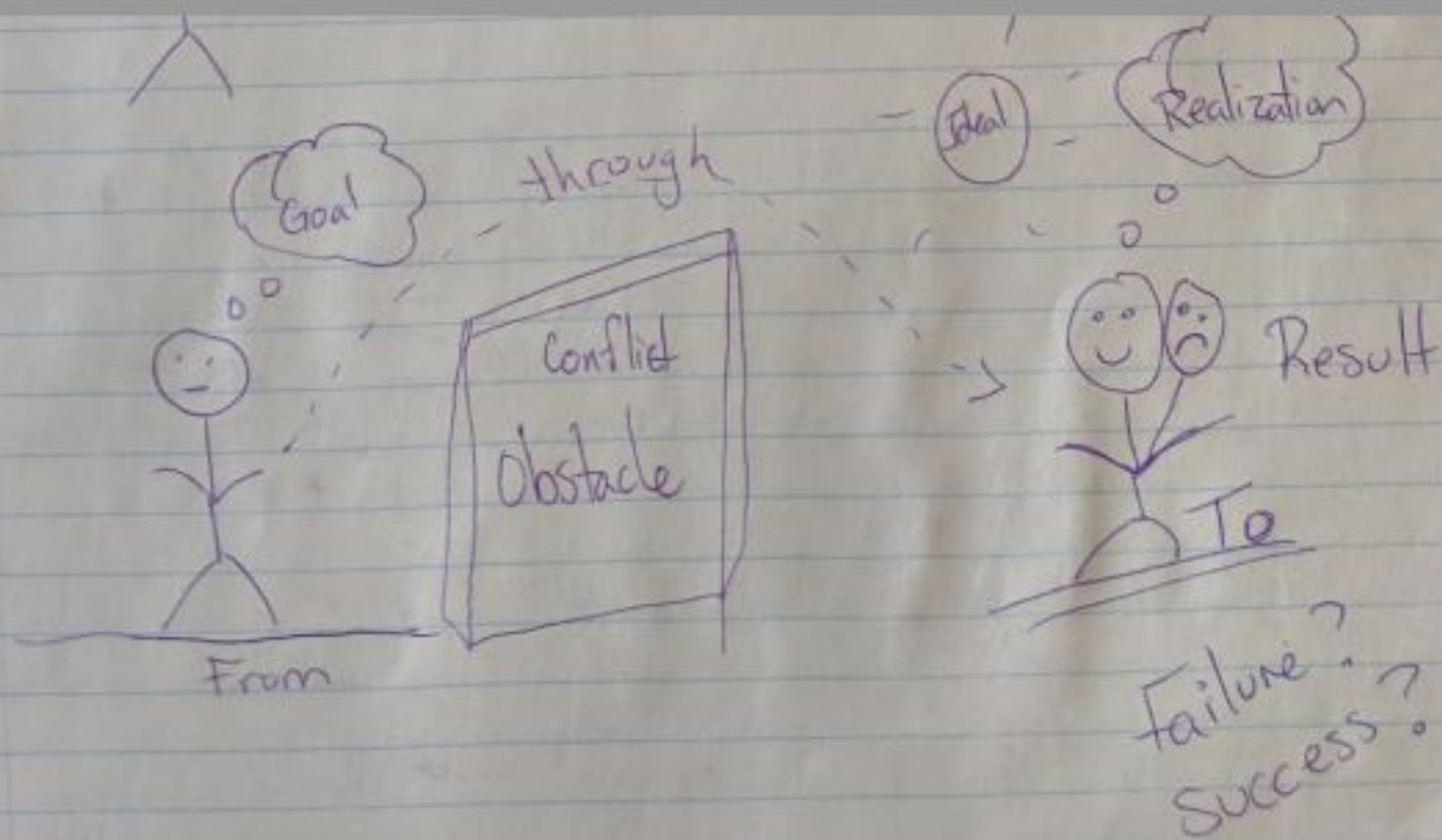
Body 3

So

Result / Realization

To

Impact



SENTENCE STARTERS

When an individual (has a goal) **they are** (impacted by the conflict) **which** (leads to a result/realization)
(starts from) (going through) (leads to)

When an individual encounters (an obstacle) **they respond** (by) **which results in** (.....).

EXAMPLE THESIS STATEMENTS

When an individual faces adversity, one must continue to fight for survival in order to persevere and allow one to recognize the potential ability to overcome fear.

Hope is an important quality because it gives us the will to persevere through challenges.

EXAMPLE - INTRO

Our imagination is like a good book. It can take us to places that we never dreamed of and allow us to escape reality for a short period of time. Consequently, living in an imaginary world is only temporary for one is soon forced back into their reality. **(Introduces the topic of imagination broadly)** In the short story, “Horses of the Night”, Margaret Laurence depicts a young sensitive man, Chris, who lives in a fantasy world created by his imagination. **(Introduces topic of imagination in your chosen text)** Chris resorts to this to escape the isolation, loneliness, and brutality of his real world, and by doing so, makes his life more bearable and fulfilling. **(Goal)** When his fragile world is shattered and he is forced to face the horrific reality of a world war, his only choice is to escape into denial and madness. **(Conflict/Result)** **When an individual allows his imagination to blur reality, it can have devastating and tragic results.** **(Thesis statement/ What you are proving in the essay)**

OTHER THESIS STATEMENTS

Allowing imagination to blur one's reality can have both positive and negative effects. One can escape from the harsh realities of life for a time; however, when that façade is shattered, one is left with the stark reality of their life.

When an individual allows their imagination to override reality, the results can be quite devastating and tragic when one is forced to view himself and the world realistically.

EXAMPLE - INTRO

When life becomes overwhelming and individual's are in need of a break, it is common to see one escape into an imaginary world of books, music and media. However, sometimes this escape is a sign of bigger issues under the surface. *(Introduces the diploma topic)* In the short story "Miss Brill," Katherine Mansfield depicts an elderly woman who lives within a fantasy world created by her imagination. *(Topic sentence introduces the key word from the topic and the literature selected.)* She resorts to this to escape from the isolation and loneliness of her real world, and, by so doing, her life becomes more interesting and fulfilling. In her fantasy world, she experiences a sense of contentment as she imagines herself as an important part of other people's lives and as possessing a life better than those around her. *(Addresses the character's goal, as well as a brief synopsis of plot and insights that connect the diploma topic and literature together)* Unfortunately, her fragile world is shattered, forcing her to face the gloomy reality of the life she truly lives. *(Conflict and result)* When an individual's feelings of contentment and self-worth are destroyed, once they realize the emptiness and loneliness of their real world, they can no longer live in their imaginary world. *(thesis: includes the topic and controlling idea)*

BODY PARAGRAPHS

3 main ideas from THESIS ---> create: Topic Sentences

Topic sentence

Point

Evidence

Analyze

Link



Topic sentence

Point

Evidence

Technique (if possible)

Analyze

Link



Grade 11 and 12 → PEEL and PETAL can go where needed

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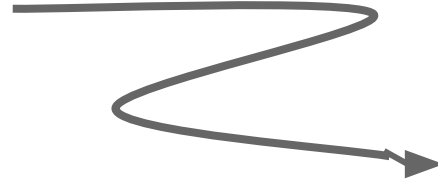
TOPIC SENTENCES

Body 1:

- Miss Brill is content and happy to live within her fantasy life; a wonderful world within her own **imagination** where she **escapes from isolation and loneliness**. *(Topic sentence includes the goal and connects it to the diploma topic)*

....

Ultimately, Miss. Brill has created a fantasy for herself that allows her to reject the truth of her sad and lonely reality. *(Conclude the paragraph by connecting back to the topic sentence idea and rewording it)*



Body 2:

- Ironically, as Miss Brill observes the other people, especially those occupying benches and chairs, she fails to see the parallel between them and herself due to how she has immersed herself into the fantasy. *(transition and topic sentence for the second supporting idea: imagining she is important to other people's lives, this creates a conflict for the character)*

TOPIC SENTENCES

Body 3:

- Despite her excitement with her imaginary world, Miss Brill overhears a conversation which completely shatters her illusions and alters her life.
(Topic sentence to support the main idea that her world is shattered)

BODY 1 → PEE

- Miss Brill is a keen observer of the people around her and she weaves what she hears and sees into imaginative, glamorous events. She notices an elderly gentleman in a velvet coat, and a woman with knitting in her lap. She is disappointed that they are not speaking as she had become quite expert “at listening to people’s conversations, as though she wasn’t listening”. Miss Brill turns her attention to other people and their activities around her in order to avoid her reality and create a new one.

BODY 2 → PEE + PETAL

Miss Brill finds that her world often includes those who are less desirable. She notes that Sunday after Sunday, the same people are drawn to the park and that “something is funny” about them: “They were odd, silent, nearly all old, and from the way they stared, they looked as though they’d come from dark little rooms or even cupboards”. She perceives these people as being less than herself, and even feels pity towards them. As well, she does not see herself as being rejected like the violets the young woman throws away or like the woman in the ermine toque who is being carelessly tossed aside by the man in the suit. Even more sad is that Miss Brill, wearing her own antique fur piece, cannot see her own image mirrored in the woman who appears as shabby as the ermine fur she wears. The juxtaposition between the ermine toque and Miss Brill serves to illustrate the past life that Miss Brill has been unable to escape; thus causing her loneliness and her desire to retreat into her own world of fantasy. Miss Brill, rather, imagines herself as being superior to these people; an intricate part of the stage performance that is reenacted in the park each week. Additionally, when she reads to the elderly gentleman, she views herself as an “actress”, not a mere English teacher. Her imaginary world is indeed more fulfilling than the dull reality of her life.

BODY 3 → PETAL (WITH EXTRA EVIDENCE/ANALYSIS)

Miss Brill is content to live in her world of fantasy where she views herself as an integral piece. Yet, when a boy and girl sit near her and the boy wishes to kiss the girl but she insists that she cannot let him because of that “stupid old thing at the end there”. The girl then begins to giggle at the the poor old soul wearing the fur that “looks like a fried whitting or fish”. Miss Brill is shocked when she realizes that the young couple are mocking her. She leaves the park, not bothering to stop for her ritualistic slice of honey cake, and hurries home. She is unable to process this new information without adjusting her view of reality. Once inside her home, she realizes how her dark room is, “like a cupboard.” Her world is no longer bright and splendid, but depressing and stark in reality. Her fur piece symbolizes the shabbiness of her life, and as she replaces it in the box, she imagines she hears something crying...it is her. Although Miss Brill seeks contentment, by trying to create a world where she is important, the loneliness of her life is finally realized. One sees how devastating this is to her for, as she cannot help but weep at this realization.

CONCLUSION

Restate thesis in other words

Sum up main points from 3 body paragraphs
(character progression: from/through/to **or**
goal/conflict/result or realization)

Universal Statement – concluding sentence(s) that sum up the theme, without sounding preachy, and relates it to life in general

EXAMPLE CONCLUSION

- In *Miss Brill*, Mansfield emphasizes the negative effects of the imagination, and the results when imagination is allowed to blur one's view of reality. (**Revisits the thesis in the introduction**) Initially, Miss Brill is content living within the parameters of a fantasy world where she feels that she is an integral part of the world around her; she is part of the performance. Conversely, when this illusion is shattered, the harshness of the reality she is compelled to face is devastating to her internal identity. (**Summary of the change the character goes through- goal, conflict, result**). It is clear that when an individual chooses to live in a fantasy world and rejects reality, and that when they are finally forced to face the truths of that life, the effects are harsh and damaging to one's inner perception of self. (**Thematic statement showing what is learnt about life through this character**).

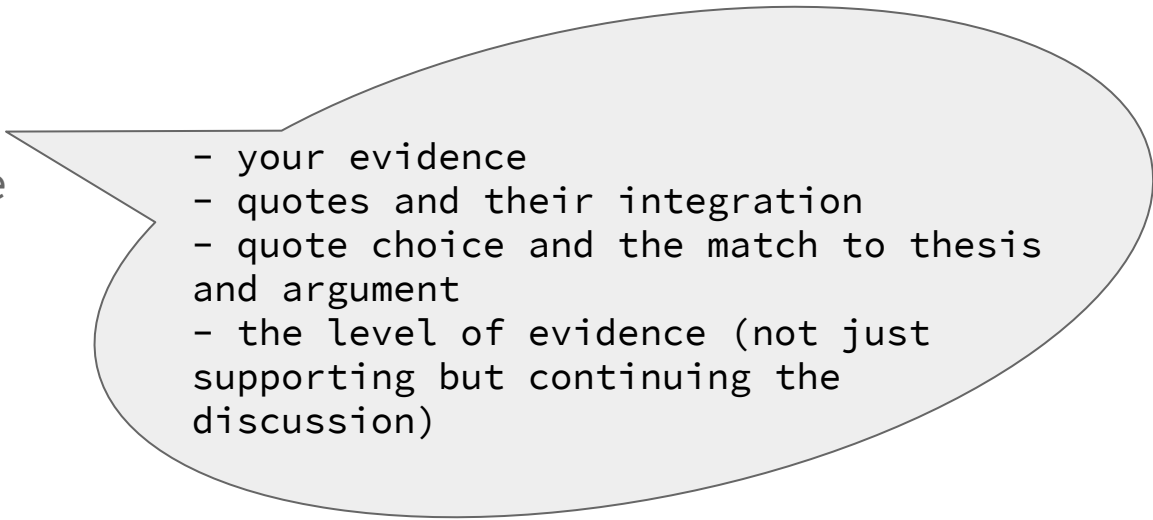
GRADING CATEGORIES

Double the points:

- 
- your ideas
 - comments
 - gained in discussion
 - thesis and argument unity
 - analysis of text

Thought & Understanding

Supporting Evidence

- 
- your evidence
 - quotes and their integration
 - quote choice and the match to thesis and argument
 - the level of evidence (not just supporting but continuing the discussion)

GRADING CATEGORIES

- organization of essay (external)
- thesis and unity
- internal org. (PEAL)
- topic sentences

Structure

Matters of Choice



- voice and style
- vocabulary
- unity of thought
- flow of sentences and ideas

Matters of Correctness

- sentence structure
- punctuation
- grammar